PRESENTATION AIDS

Presentation aids



Introduction:

Presentation aids are the resources beyond the speech itself and delivery that a speaker uses to enhance the message conveyed to the audience. The type of presentation aids that speakers most typically make use of are visual aids: pictures, diagrams, charts and graphs, maps, and the like. Audible aids include musical excerpts, audio speech excerpts, and sound effects.

Using presentation aids can be risky. However, with a little forethought and adequate practice, you can choose presentation aids that enhance your message and boost your professional appearance in front of an audience.

To be effective, presentation aids must also be easy to use and easy for the listeners to see and understand

Functions of presentation aids



Why should you use presentation aids? If you have prepared and rehearsed your speech adequately, shouldn't a good speech with a good delivery be enough to stand on its own?

- improve your audience's understanding of the information you are conveying (by clarifying or emphasizing the point being made),
- enhance audience memory and retention of the message,
- add variety and interest to your speech,
- and enhance your credibility as a speaker

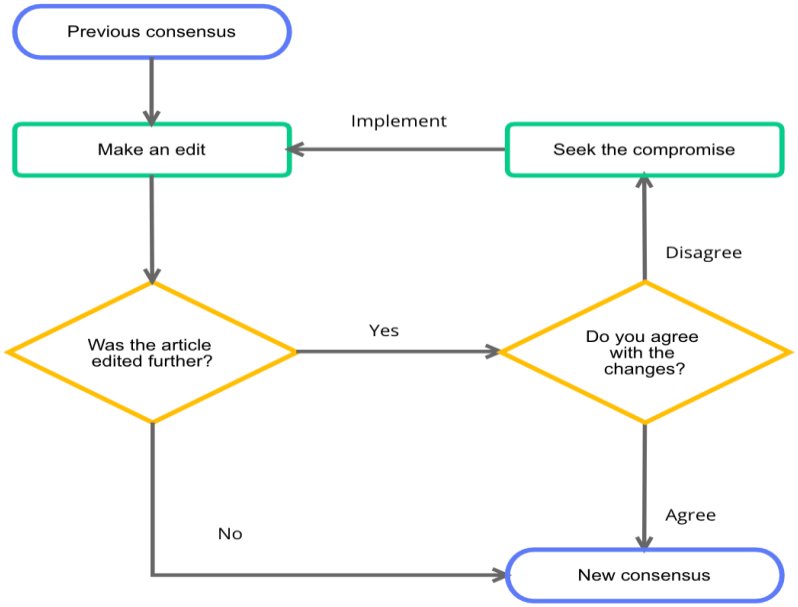
Types of presentation aids

Let's look at the most common types of visual aids

1. Charts:

A chart is commonly defined as a graphical representation of data (often numerical) or a sketch representing an ordered process. Whether you create your charts or do research to find charts that already exist, it is important for them to exactly match the specific purpose in your speech.

Congenital Anomalies	Relative Risk	Nunmber of Smokers N = 1,943	Number of Nonsmokers N = 16,073	95% CI	*p*-Value
Cardiovascular System	1.56	43	217	1.12–2.19	$p < .01$
Skeletal System	1.11	19	139	0.68–1.82	NS
Hematologic System	1.39	20	121	0.86–2.25	NS
Nervous System	1.30	4	25	0.91–1.86	NS
Pulmonary System	1.25	7	39	0.55–2.84	NS
Gastrointestinal System	0.54	1	17	0.07–4.11	NS



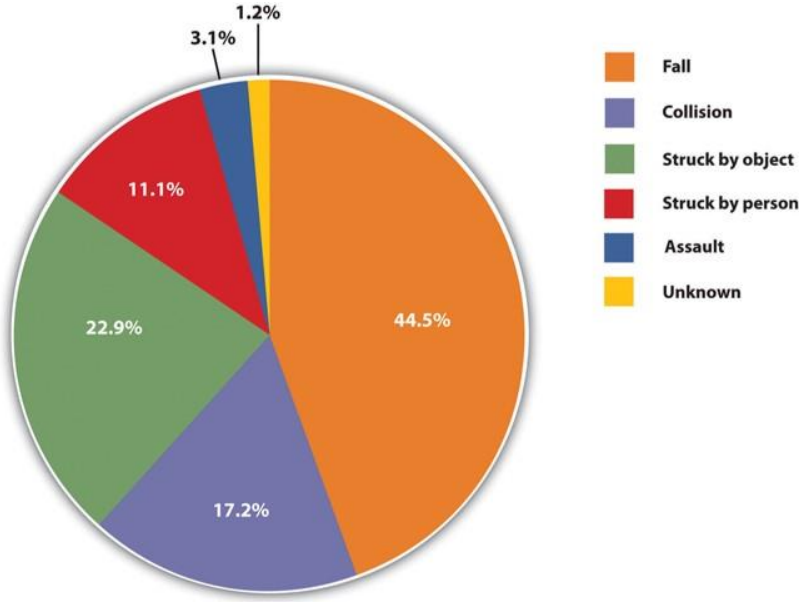
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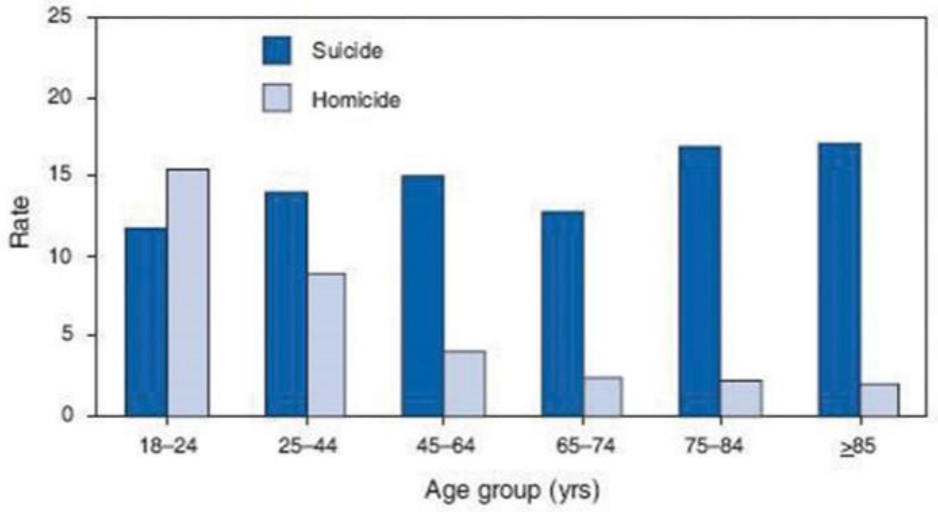
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2. Graphs:

A graph may be considered a type of chart, but graphs are so widely used that we will discuss them separately.

A graph is a pictorial representation of the relationships of quantitative data using dots, lines, bars, pie slices, and the like. Graphs show how one factor (such as size, weight, number of items) varies in comparison to other items.





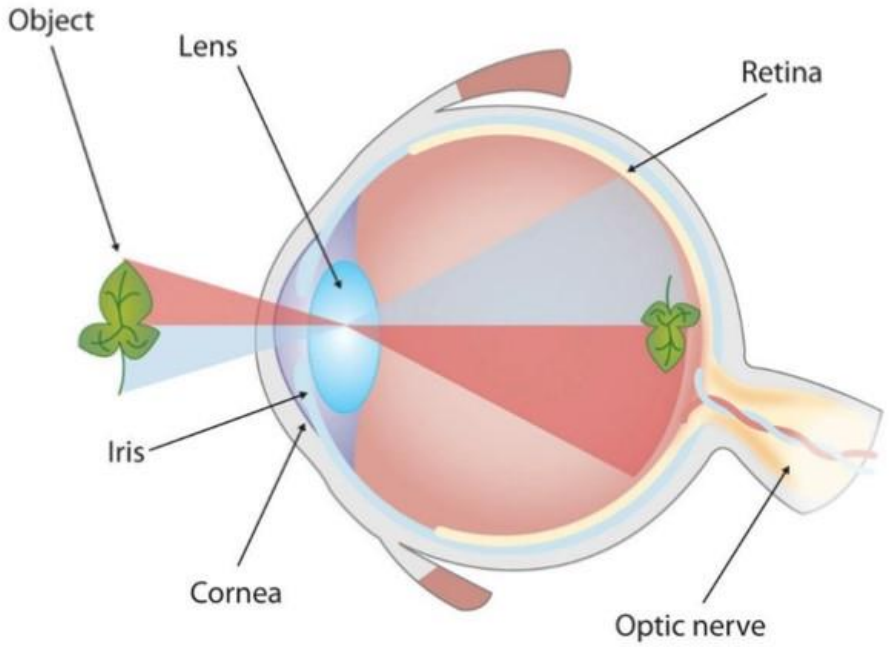
Types of presentation aids

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3. Diagrams:

Diagrams are drawings or sketches that outline and explain the parts of an object, process, or occurrence that cannot be readily seen.

When you use a diagram, be sure to explain each part of the concept, paying special attention to elements that are complicated or prone to misunderstanding.





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4. Video or audio recordings:

Another very useful type of presentation aid is a video or audio recording. Whether it is a short video from a website such as YouTube or Vimeo, a segment from a song, or a piece of a podcast, a well-chosen video or audio recording may be a good choice to enhance your speech.



Note the following when using video or audio aids:

- Do not use a clip that is too long for the overall speech
- Practice with the audio or video equipment prior to speaking
- The audience must be given context before a video or audio clip is played, specifically what the clip is and why it relates to the speech

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5. Objects or models:

Objects refer to anything you could hold up and talk about during your speech. Models, on the other hand, are re-creations of physical objects that you cannot have readily available with you during a speech (for example, a body part or building).

As much as possible, a speaker should not pass an object or model around during a speech. It is highly distracting.

6. People:

Speakers can often use their own bodies to demonstrate facets of a speech. In some cases, such as for a demonstration speech, you might want to ask someone else to serve as your presentation aid.

The transaction between you and your human presentation aid must be appropriate, especially if you are going to demonstrate something like a dance step. In short, make sure your helper will know what is expected of them and consents to it.

Tips for using presentation aids

- The audience must be able to see and understand the presentation aid.
- It must deliver clear information, and it must not distract from the message.
- Avoid overly elaborate presentation aids because they can distract the audience's attention from your message, don't put too many elements into your visual aid
- Select visual aids that will have the greatest impact on your audience
- Reveal your visuals only when they are relevant to your current point, and take them away when they are no longer being talked about
- Speak to your audience not to your visual aid or the screen
- Keep your presentation aids within the limits of the working technology available to you
- Practice with your visual aids and make sure all demonstrations work smoothly
- Be prepared to move on with your presentation should any of the visual aids falter or fail. No matter how great your visuals are, you need to be prepared to speak without them

Virtual speeches and Presentations/Slideshows

With the advent of the COVID-19 era and most events being virtual, one of the most common and applicable visual aids will be your presentation/slideshow.

Note the following points when preparing your presentation.

- Generally it is best to use a single font for the text on your visuals so that they look like a unified set. Or you can use two different fonts in consistent ways, such as having all headings and titles in the same font and all bullet points in the same font
- It is essential to make sure the information is large enough for the audience to see
- High contrast between the text and slides is extremely important. White fonts against very dark backgrounds and black fonts against very light backgrounds are most recommended
- Avoid words on photos
- Balance the colours used on your slides
- Do not put too much information on the page, it should serve as your outline, not a script.

What are the errors here?

How to make a Good First Impression



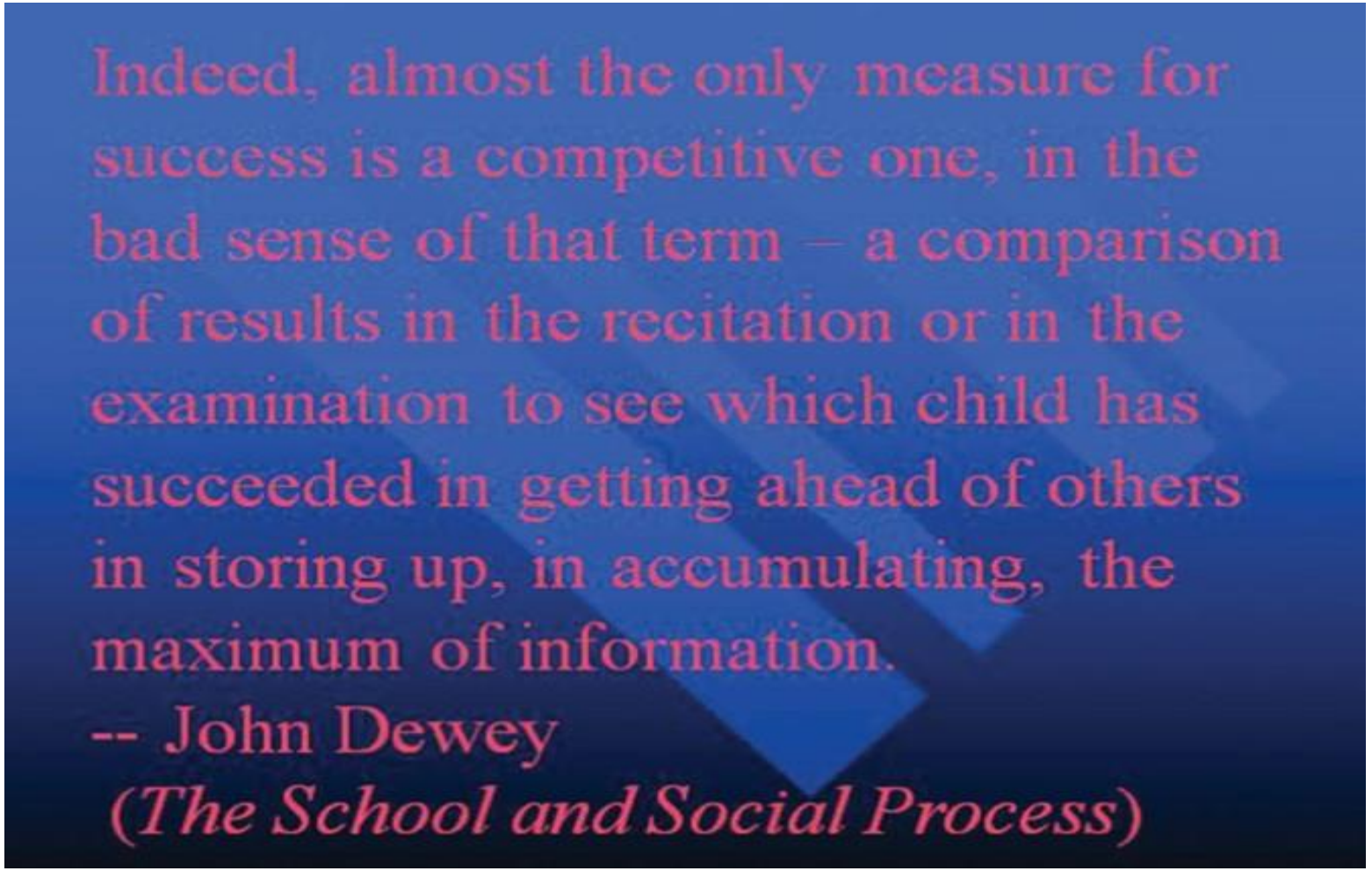
Making a first good impression can be vital when looking for a new job. Whether we like it or not, people do judge a book by their cover. The first few seconds with someone can be critical to your career.

- Be on time. The person you are just meeting is probably not interested in your excuses, even if it is the first time you are late in your whole life. All they are going to know is that you are not keeping up with a previous agreement. The image you are leaving behind is of someone that is not reliable. Make an extra effort and make sure to arrive on time. Too early is always better than too late.
- Be prepared. Before going to your interview you should have done your research about the company, the position you're applying for, and so on. Think about what kind of questions you could be asked, and how you would answer them. In one word, practice!
- Take care of your clothes and your overall grooming. It has been said that 55% can be determined by the person's appearance. So be careful when choosing how to present yourself in an interview. Dress to impress, maintaining in mind the job you are applying to, and when in doubt, choose the most conservative choice.
- Take into consideration non-verbal communication. You might bee feeling nervous, but studies have shown that people who present themselves in a more friendly, confident manner usually have better results. Something as simple as a smile can make a difference.

What are the errors here?



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ANY QUESTIONS?

